

2.1 Conception And Content

Like we said, PowerPoint is only the tool. It's unfortunate, but we must begin with a "do not": Do not fire up the software and start preparing your slides, even if you have all your data and charts ready. Be calm. We don't like to sound preachy, so let's just say we'll leave it up to you whether you find the following methodology useful.

2.1.1 Five Steps To Fine Slides

Step 1

The first thing you should fire up is Notepad, or Word, or a mind mapping software, depending on what you're comfortable with or used to. First, ideate.

Recall your key points. A good rule is to limit your presentation to about six points. For example, if it's about a property your company is planning on acquiring, the points could be cost, location, quality of the premises, key benefits, and employee issues. If it's a presentation to children about how maths can be interesting, the key points could be that: it's not really hard, you need to do practical experiments, you can try and solve puzzles, it can be addictive, don't be put off by the symbols, and that it can unleash your creativity.

Always bear your central formulation in mind throughout the creation of your presentation. The idea, again, is ideas; *what you need to convey* is paramount—above structure, above spacing, above drawings, above design, above everything.

Step 2

After you're done with the creative, analytical and critical part of the task—ideation—you can start slapping the results into PowerPoint. Be patient again. Do not create your actual slides just yet. Make rough slides. Plan how many slides will comprise the show, what data and text should go where, and so on. In other